# 2.2. BIOPHILIC URBANISM (SUSTAINABLE FUTURES BY DESIGN MODULE, UCL, LONDON, UK 2023)

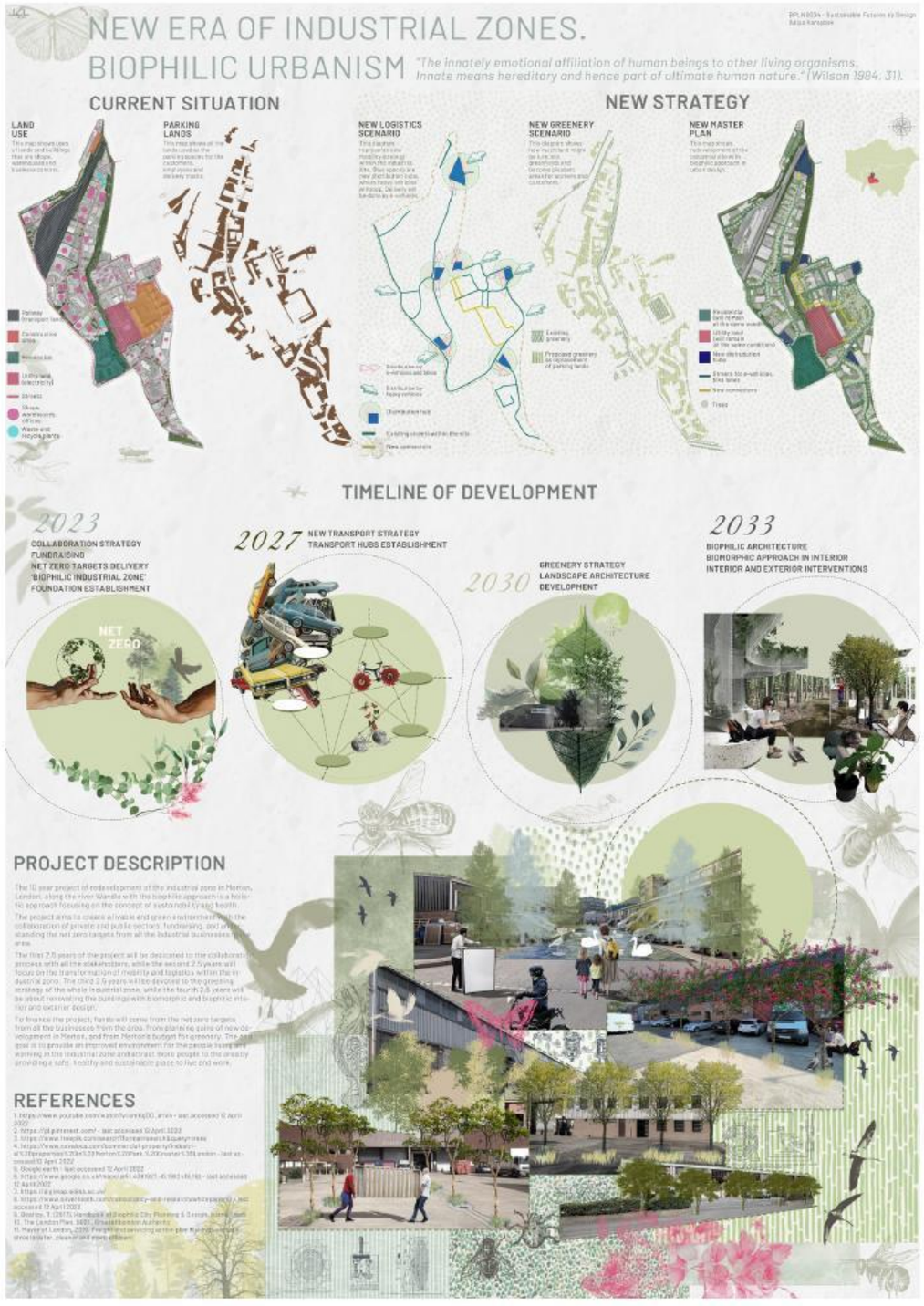
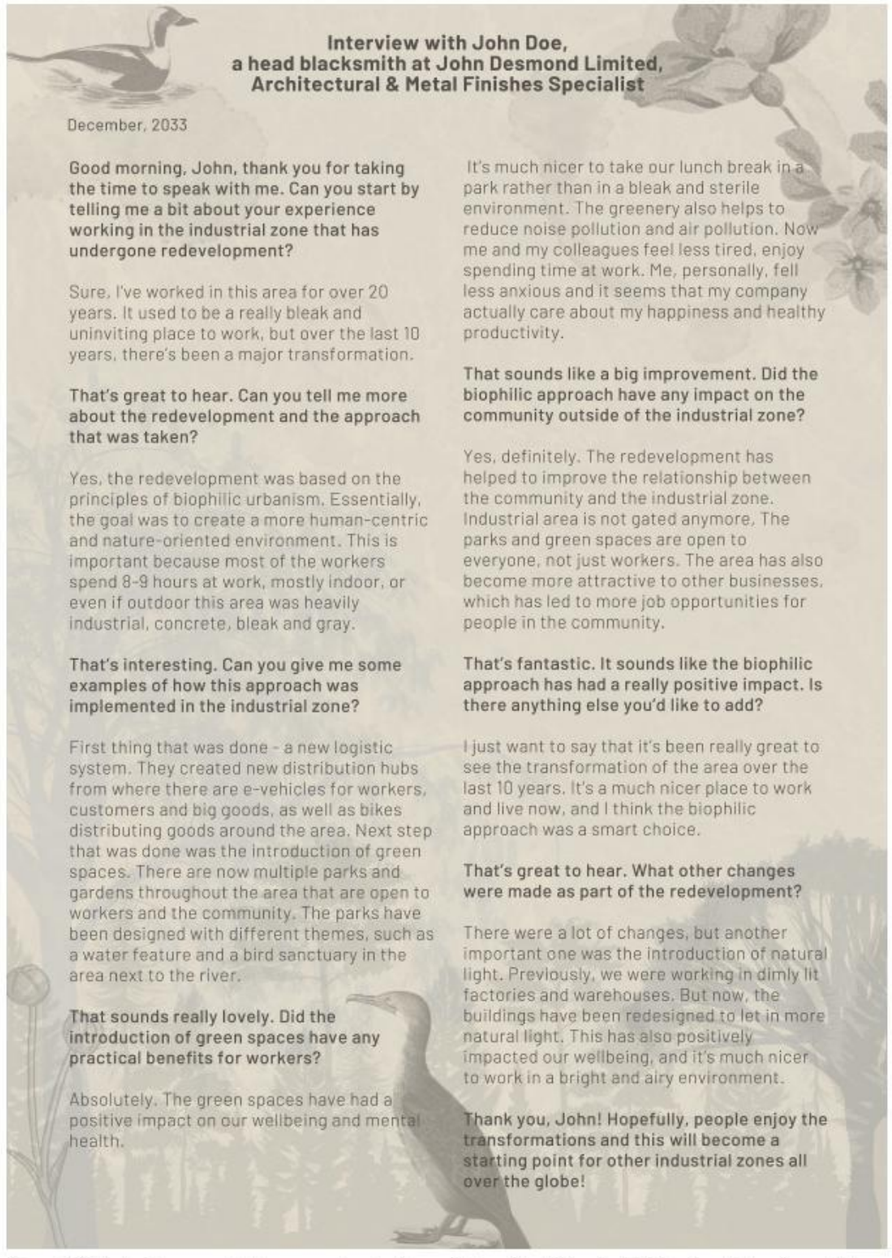



*Figure 2.3: Poster 1 showcases the urban and landscape interventions to the strategic industrial zone in South London along the river Wandle valley via biophilic design philosophy*



**Interview with John Doe,**
**a head blacksmith at John Desmond Limited,**
**Architectural & Metal Finishes Specialist**

December, 2033

**Good morning, John, thank you for taking the time to speak with me. Can you start by telling me a bit about your experience working in the industrial zone that has undergone redevelopment?**

Sure, I've worked in this area for over 20 years. It used to be a really bleak and uninviting place to work, but over the last 10 years, there's been a major transformation.

**That's great to hear. Can you tell me more about the redevelopment and the approach that was taken?**

Yes, the redevelopment was based on the principles of biophilic urbanism. Essentially, the goal was to create a more human-centric and nature-oriented environment. This is important because most of the workers spend 8-9 hours at work, mostly indoor, or even if outdoor this area was heavily industrial, concrete, bleak and gray.

**That's interesting. Can you give me some examples of how this approach was implemented in the industrial zone?**

First thing that was done - a new logistic system. They created new distribution hubs from where there are e-vehicles for workers, customers and big goods, as well as bikes distributing goods around the area. Next step that was done was the introduction of green spaces. There are now multiple parks and gardens throughout the area that are open to workers and the community. The parks have been designed with different themes, such as a water feature and a bird sanctuary in the area next to the river.

**That sounds really lovely. Did the introduction of green spaces have any practical benefits for workers?**

Absolutely. The green spaces have had a positive impact on our wellbeing and mental health.

It's much nicer to take our lunch break in a park rather than in a bleak and sterile environment. The greenery also helps to reduce noise pollution and air pollution. Now me and my colleagues feel less tired, enjoy spending time at work. Me, personally, fell less anxious and it seems that my company actually care about my happiness and healthy productivity.

**That sounds like a big improvement. Did the biophilic approach have any impact on the community outside of the industrial zone?**

Yes, definitely. The redevelopment has helped to improve the relationship between the community and the industrial zone. Industrial area is not gated anymore. The parks and green spaces are open to everyone, not just workers. The area has also become more attractive to other businesses, which has led to more job opportunities for people in the community.

**That's fantastic. It sounds like the biophilic approach has had a really positive impact. Is there anything else you'd like to add?**

I just want to say that it's been really great to see the transformation of the area over the last 10 years. It's a much nicer place to work and live now, and I think the biophilic approach was a smart choice.

**That's great to hear. What other changes were made as part of the redevelopment?**

There were a lot of changes, but another important one was the introduction of natural light. Previously, we were working in dimly lit factories and warehouses. But now, the buildings have been redesigned to let in more natural light. This has also positively impacted our wellbeing, and it's much nicer to work in a bright and airy environment.

**Thank you, John! Hopefully, people enjoy the transformations and this will become a starting point for other industrial zones all over the globe!**

*Figure 2.4: Poster 2 represents the second part of the article entitled 'Creative Writing,' in which a journalist conducts an interview with a worker in the industrial zone. This is after 10 years of implementing design ideas.*

**My role:** I developed this project individually.